

Liquid cooling kits Only for bragging rights

It wasn't too long ago when overclocking one's PC meant cranking up on hardware that replicated northern India's summer heat waves inside the cabinet. For enthusiasts, the answer has almost always been to opt for a liquid cooling kit to keep their PC's CPU and GPU temperatures in check. However, in 2012, overclocking buffs shouldn't instinctively make a grab for the coolest liquid cooling solution out there, since it may quickly be turning into a fad – unless you're trying to compete in a global overclocking competition.

With Intel's LGA 1155 CPUs, it has generally been observed that high-end air coolers are able to provide just as much overclocking potential as a good liquid cooling kit for your CPU. The area of GPU overclocking still benefits from liquid cooling setups, however they're very expensive. As far as CPU overclocking is concerned, liquid cooling kits may not be as great an option as they used to be five or six years ago.

Portable speakers Mostly effective

This is definitely a good idea. While testing laptops, smartphones, tablets and other mobile computing devices, we've learned that the onboard audio on most of these devices is generally underwhelming and doesn't match up to a decently performing external audio solution – this is natural, since mobile devices have form factor and weight restrictions which limit their audio output and quality severely.

But this problem is immediately solved by connecting your laptop, smartphone, tablet, etc., to a portable speaker that either connects via a 3.5mm jack, USB port or, in some cases, bluetooth. Don't buy the cheapest, most inexpensive portable speaker out there, but if you spend over ₹1,000, you should be able to find a well performing portable speaker for your mobile device.



Portable speakers are a good alternative to onboard audio

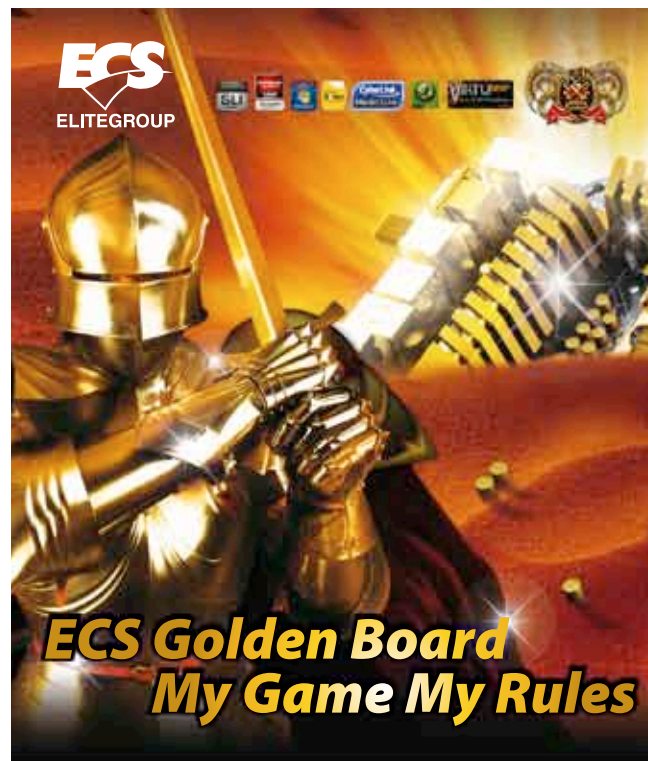
Tablet bag/case Yes and no

If you've newly acquired a tablet, either an iPad or one of the myriad Android alternatives, you'll soon be concerned about preserving its scratch-free surface and purchasing a bag that helps you easily stow away your tablet.

While purchasing your tablet bag, it's important to distinguish between what's cool and what's not, irrespective of how cool your tablet inside it may be. We absolutely love the Cocoon GRID-IT Wraps which accommodates 10-inch and 7-inch tablets. The bag takes care not only of the tablet but also of your phone, charger wire, earphones with space for plenty of other electronic accessories. Check out <http://dgit.in/I5rPOs> for more. On the other hand, beware of buying something like Assero Defender (<http://dgit.in/JL9ePN>) – it's a glorified child backpack carrier, and seriously uncool. 



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ECS Golden Board My Game My Rules

Z77H2-A2X



- LGA1155 CPU
- Intel® Z77 Chipset
- 2 PCIe Gen3 x 16
- 2 PCIe Gen2 x 1
- 2 PCI
- 4 Dual-channel DDR3 2800(OC) / 2600(OC) / 2400(OC)
- 4 SATA 6Gb/s (RAID 0,1,5,10)
- 2 SATA 3Gb/s
- 6 USB 3.0 / 6 USB 2.0



H77H2-M3



- LGA1155 CPU
- Intel® H77 Chipset
- 1 PCIe Gen3 x 16
- 1 PCIe Gen2 x 1
- 2 PCI
- 2 Dual-channel DDR3 1600 / 1333 / 1066
- 2 SATA 6Gb/s (RAID 0,1,5,10)
- 4 SATA 3Gb/s
- 4 USB 3.0 / 10 USB 2.0



H61H2-M2



- LGA1155 CPU
- Intel® H61 Chipset
- 1 PCIe x 16, 2 PCIe x 1
- 2 Dual-channel DDR3 1333
- 1 HDMI (Optional), 1 DVI, 1 D-Sub
- 4 SATA 3Gb/s
- 8 USB 2.0



G41T-M7



- LGA775 CPU
- Intel® G41+ICH7 Chipset
- 1 PCIe x 16, 1 PCIe x 1, 1 PCI
- 2 Dual-channel DDR3 1333 (OC) / 1066 / 800
- 1 D-Sub
- 2 SATA 3Gb/s
- 8 USB 2.0



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